PRODUCT CASE STUDY

Identity Authentication System

How greytHR eliminated employee document fraud for blue-collar industries

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02 The Problem

greytHR serves 20,000+ businesses including manufacturing, construction, and consumer goods sectors employing large blue-collar workforces. These employees often lacked standard documentation, creating a systemic identity verification gap.

Fake Identity Documents

Employees submitted fraudulent Aadhaar/PAN numbers, sometimes using colleagues' or family members' details to pass background checks undetected.

Manual & Costly Verification

Companies relied on expensive third-party background checks taking days or weeks, or skipped verification entirely due to cost and complexity.

Data Entry Errors Undetected

Format-only field validation failed to catch manual entry mistakes, leading to incorrect employee records and compliance risks.

How it was discovered: A pattern emerged while reviewing new customer requests. Follow-up interviews with customers across manufacturing, construction, and consumer goods confirmed the scale of the problem.

03

My Role & Process

Team: PM + 2 Engineers · Timeline: 1 Month

1 Discovery

Analysed customer support requests
Identified fraud pattern across verticals
Interviewed customers from 3 industries

2 Research & Decision

Evaluated build vs. buy
Chose third-party API integration
Decision: effort, resources & urgency

3 Define & Design

Wrote PRD & user stories
Defined Aadhaar & PAN auth flows
Designed admin-facing verification UI

4 Build & Test

Worked with 2 engineers on API
Wrote test cases & UAT
Validated data pull from govt. portal

5 Launch & GTM

Launched as consumption-based add-on
Priced at 20% margin over API
Onboarded clients

04 The Solution

A real-time identity verification system integrated with India's government statutory portals (Aadhaar & PAN), enabling instant authentication at zero manual effort.

HR Admin enters ID number → System sends request to Govt. portal → Govt. portal authenticates & returns data → Verified info auto-fills HRMS — non-editable

KEY DECISIONS

- Build vs. Buy → Chose third-party API for speed and lower engineering effort
- Consumption-based pricing → Charged at 20% margin over API cost, reducing upfront barrier
- Non-editable verified fields → Prevents post-verification data tampering
- Launched Aadhaar + PAN → Covers India's two primary government identity documents

05 Outcome & Learnings

32

Enterprise customers adopted within 6 months

3%

Incremental revenue contribution after launch

1 mo

Discovery to full launch

Fraudulent and duplicate Identity document entries completely eliminated for all 32 adopting customers

LEARNINGS

- Build vs. Buy decisions should always weigh time-to-market — choosing a third-party API let us ship in 1 month instead of 3+
- Mixed adoption revealed a GTM gap — customer education on compliance benefits should be built into the launch plan from day one
- Consumption pricing lowered the adoption barrier but required careful margin modelling to ensure sustainable revenue